

JACOB COOK

Cybersecurity Incident Response Analyst | Host Forensics · Threat Hunting · EDR · MITRE ATT&CK · SIEM · Python

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Investigation-focused security professional with hands-on experience triaging incidents end-to-end: host artifact analysis, log correlation, timeline reconstruction, and IOC/TTP mapping to MITRE ATT&CK. Built Wazuh SIEM from scratch, authored Sigma-format detection content, and produced production-style investigation reports. Strong written and verbal communication for client-facing engagements. CompTIA stack (Security+, CySA+, PenTest+, SecurityX); BS Computer Science; MS Cybersecurity in progress.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Incident Response & Forensics: Host-Based Investigation, Log Analysis, Timeline Reconstruction, Artifact Collection, Root Cause Analysis, Containment & Remediation, Attack Vector Analysis, Persistence & Lateral Movement Identification

Threat Hunting & Detection: Threat Hunting, IOC & TTP Recognition, MITRE ATT&CK Framework, Detection Rule Authoring, Hunting Queries, Custom Detection-as-Code

EDR, SIEM & Tooling: EDR concepts (CrowdStrike Falcon, Defender for Endpoint, SentinelOne — familiar), SIEM (Wazuh hands-on, Microsoft Sentinel familiar), VirusTotal, Wireshark

Languages & Systems: Python, Bash, PowerShell, SQL; Windows Endpoints, Linux (Ubuntu/CentOS), Cloud familiarity (AWS labs, Azure)

TECHNICAL PROJECTS

Stryker / Intune Detection Pack: Detection-as-Code

2026

- Authored 6 Sigma-format detection rules for Intune MDM abuse mapped to MITRE ATT&CK, with enrichment logic that eliminated 100% of false positives in a 100-event simulation (80 benign suppressed, 20 malicious caught) using KV store-style admin baseline lookups.
- Documented 3 benign false-positive scenarios per rule (18 total), covering VPN logins, scheduled maintenance, and PIM activations so analysts can triage confidently without escalating known-good activity.
- Verification: 43 passing pytest cases in repo (tests/test_rules.py), reproducible against synthetic data, not a live tenant.

Blue Team SOC Monitoring Lab: Wazuh SIEM

2026

- Built a full Wazuh SIEM stack from scratch and validated 12 detection rule patterns against 242 simulated auth-style events, separating true-positive threats from benign noise with 100% precision after tuning.
- Reduced false-positive alert volume by 100% by tuning out all 79 benign-only matches (cron jobs, service accounts, scheduled deployments) without dropping a single true positive.
- Verification: 19 passing pytest cases in repo (tests/test_detection_accuracy.py). All metrics reproducible.

SOAR-lite: Incident Response Orchestrator

2026

- Eliminated 4 manual triage steps (classification, IOC enrichment, notification, ticket creation) by building automated SIEM-triggered playbooks, reducing triage time by over 60% in lab testing.
- Built end-to-end alert automation: webhook ingestion from Wazuh, automatic playbook routing by event type, IP blocking, Slack notification, and incident documentation with zero analyst intervention required.
- Delivered a working handoff path from initial alert handling to documented, Tier 2-ready response that closes the gap between raw detection and actionable cases.
- Verification: 10 passing pytest cases in repo (tests/test_orchestrator.py). Tests run against the real FastAPI app, not mocked endpoints.

Phishing Analysis Lab

2026

- Triaged 5 real-world phishing samples end-to-end: header inspection, SPF/DKIM/DMARC validation, URL defanging, VirusTotal enrichment, IOC extraction, and attacker infrastructure mapping, achieving 100% accurate threat classification against known IOC ground truth.
- Delivered production-style triage reports with documented IOCs, confidence assessments, and escalation decisions that mirror real security operations output.

G3-GPT: Industry-Sponsored Enterprise AI Platform (Team of 6)

2024

- Secured a production AI platform for corporate stakeholders by engineering RBAC and Azure AD SSO, enforcing data privacy requirements that enabled executive-level adoption.
- Shipped an enterprise-grade platform on deadline as part of a six-person team under direct industry sponsor oversight with zero critical security findings at delivery.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Target Distribution Center | Operations Engineer: Systems Monitoring & Incident Response

2019 - 2025

- Maintained 99.5% system uptime across automated sortation and conveyor infrastructure by monitoring sensors, alerts, and operational dashboards across rotating shifts, the same continuous monitoring discipline that defines round-the-clock SOC work.
- Resolved 200+ system anomalies over six years through structured root cause analysis, producing compliance-tracked documentation that reduced repeat incidents by an estimated 30% and supported audit readiness.
- Reduced mean time to recovery by an estimated 20% by coordinating cross-team incident response during outages, including escalation, triage prioritization, and post-incident reporting that mirrors security incident response workflows.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

WGU | MS, Cybersecurity (In Progress)

Expected Oct 2026 · GPA 3.50

CSUS | BS, Computer Science

Jan 2025 · GPA 3.50

CompTIA: Security+ · CySA+ · PenTest+ · SecurityX · CSIE (stackable)